

Competitor Gap Pass for Memba

Research date: May 2026. The gap pass changes the picture materially. The strongest newly-surfaced threats are **not** the legacy AMS names; they are a combination of **free or donor-funded platforms that crush the price floor, Commonwealth club-native systems that fit volunteer sports/recreation more closely than US nonprofit tools do, and lighter-weight community/event products that are already winning informal outdoor and activity groups**. In plain terms: Memba should assume that a prospect can already choose **\$0, very cheap club-native software, or a free social/event stack plus Stripe**, and should only count on winning if it delivers a meaningfully better **domain model** for households, renewals, privacy, waivers, volunteer handoff, and exportability. ¹

My highest-confidence conclusions are these. **Pricing differentiation is substantially weakened** by Zeffy, HelloAsso, Spond Club, Givebutter's free core CRM, and very low-cost club-native tools like membermojo and Clubforce. **Household/family differentiation survives** because most competitors still treat "family" as either a billing convenience, a lead-member-plus-linked-records workaround, or a shared account with blunt permissions rather than a true household model. **Volunteer-admin handoff remains under-served** almost everywhere. **Outdoor/activity-specific workflows**—leader roles, member-only visibility, waitlists, waivers, emergency contact handling, and lightweight trip approvals in one system—are still poorly integrated across the field, even where pieces exist. Confidence: high on price compression; medium-high on household and workflow gaps; medium on some undocumented absences in smaller vendors' public docs. ²

Executive assessment

For Memba's **Canadian outdoor-club beachhead**, the most credible immediate substitutes are **TidyHQ, Amilia, Heylo, Spond, membermojo**, and—where the club looks more like a governed sport body than a volunteer association—**SportLoMo** and **Clubforce**. **Zeffy** is the single biggest **pricing** threat, but not the single biggest **replacement** threat: it is extremely strong as a no-fee payment/form/membership-on-ramp, yet much weaker as a club operating system. **HelloAsso** matters strategically because it proves a voluntary-contribution model can work at very large scale, but it is operationally France-only. **Givebutter** and **Donorbox** are credible substitutes for nonprofits whose "membership" is really recurring giving plus events and email, but they are not clean replacements for householded member organizations that need club-native privacy and activity workflows. ³

The revised product thesis should therefore be: **do not sell "fair pricing" as the primary wedge**. Sell **"the club model others don't actually model"**—especially household/family complexity, renewal edge cases, volunteer turnover, and lightweight activity/waiver/privacy workflows that feel designed for real volunteer organizations rather than for generic fundraising, generic recreation, or chat-first groups. ⁴

Gap-competitor matrix

The matrix below is split by cohort for readability, but together it forms one gap-competitor matrix for the products in this brief plus the most relevant newly-found competitors.

Free, donor-funded, and fundraising-first platforms

Product	Primary geography and maturity	Pricing model	Family and household handling	Activity and waiver handling	Could it replace Memba for a 30–300 member outdoor club?	Key judgement
Zeffy	Canada/US-focused; Zeffy says it serves 100,000+ nonprofits and is “completely free.” ⁵	\$0 software, \$0 platform fee, \$0 transaction fee, \$0 processing fee ; funded by voluntary donor contributions . Zeffy says two out of three donors leave a contribution. ⁶	I did not find public docs in this pass showing a robust household model with one payer, multiple individual logins, dependent lifecycle, or ageing-up logic. Confidence: medium-low. ⁵	Zeffy publicly positions itself around fundraising, events, payments, and memberships; I did not verify native trip-leader, directory-privacy, or outdoor waiver workflows in the sources reviewed here. Confidence: medium-low. ⁶	Partial replacement, not full replacement. It can absolutely replace “dues form + payments + simple event tickets” for some clubs.	High pricing threat, medium operational threat. It weakens any “we’re cheaper/fairer” story badly, but it does not obviously close the household / outdoor-workflow gap. ⁶

Product	Primary geography and maturity	Pricing model	Family and household handling	Activity and waiver handling	Could it replace Memba for a 30–300 member outdoor club?	Key judgement
Givebutter	US nonprofit platform with strong momentum; TechCrunch reported a \$50M round in 2024 and described the business as profitable. ⁷	Free core platform/CRM; unlimited contacts in free CRM; optional Givebutter Plus starts at \$29/month for small contact counts. ⁸	Has CRM households and relationships , but its membership product is explicitly built via recurring donation forms/ recurring plans , not a club-native household membership model. ⁹	Strong for fundraising events and outbound email; weak evidence of native trip, waiver, emergency-contact, or club-directory privacy depth. Membership guidance is framed as donor/member communications and recurring payments. ¹⁰	For some nonprofits, yes; for outdoor clubs, only partially.	Long-term broader-market threat, weaker beachhead threat. It is a strong “membership-as-recurring-giving” alternative, but still donor-first rather than club-first. ¹¹

Product	Primary geography and maturity	Pricing model	Family and household handling	Activity and waiver handling	Could it replace Memba for a 30–300 member outdoor club?	Key judgement
Donorbox	Broad nonprofit footprint; Donorbox says it serves 100,000+ organizations in 96+ countries and has processed \$3B+ . ¹²	Standard plan free , with 2.95%–3.95% platform fees; Pro is \$150/month with lower fees; memberships and event ticketing are at the higher fee band on Standard. ¹³	Memberships support monthly and annual tiers and donor self-management, but the public materials describe a donor/member-tier model, not a true household/dependent model. I found no public household feature evidence in this pass. Confidence: medium. ¹⁴	Has event ticketing and memberships; no public evidence in the reviewed sources of outdoor-club trip roles, waivers, emergency contacts, or per-field member directory privacy. ¹⁵	Partial replacement where the club mainly needs payment collection, donor/member tiers, and event ticketing.	Moderate broader-market threat, low-medium beachhead threat. It is more credible for donor-centric nonprofits than for householded, volunteer outdoor clubs. ¹⁶

Product	Primary geography and maturity	Pricing model	Family and household handling	Activity and waiver handling	Could it replace Memba for a 30–300 member outdoor club?	Key judgement
HelloAsso	France-only collection tools for French associations/clubs; HelloAsso says it supports 450,000 associations and is “100% funded by citizens.” ¹⁷	No fees or commissions to associations; funded by voluntary contributions at checkout. HelloAsso says one payment in two includes a contribution. ¹⁸	Public docs show association membership periods, tariff structures, custom fields, consent to general terms, and renewal campaigns, but I did not verify a strong household/dependent model in this pass. ¹⁹	Documented strengths: memberships, billetterie, custom data capture, terms/consent, and scheduled/instalment payments; no verified evidence here of club-native trip approval or household-specific outdoor flows. ²⁰	Not a Canada replacement, but a very important model proof-point.	Strategic pricing threat, not a Canadian beachhead threat. It proves that “free forever via voluntary contribution” is sustainable at scale in association software. ²¹

Volunteer-org-native and club-native platforms

Product	Primary geography and maturity	Pricing model	Family and household handling	Activity and waiver handling	Could it replace Memba for a 30–300 member outdoor club?	Key judgement
TidyHQ	Australian-owned; sells across Australia, UK, US, NZ, and Ireland. ²²	Starter free; Pro AU\$79/month or AU\$890/year. Starter payment fee 3% + AU\$0.20 plus Stripe; Pro 1% + AU\$0.20 plus Stripe. ²³	One of the best audited family models in this pass: explicit Family Membership , adults and children, bundled pricing, variable pricing for first/ subsequent adults and children, and visible linked family members in admin and member views. ²⁴	Strong events, group-restricted tickets, logged-in member visibility controls, member profile/ schedule/ transactions, Google Sheets via Zapier, custom roles, emergency-contact fields via custom fields/digital cards. I did not verify native trip-leader approvals or native waiver-signature flows. ²⁵	Yes, credibly.	Top direct threat. TidyHQ is the most dangerous “club-native + volunteer-friendly + Commonwealth-ready” competitor in this pass. ²⁶

Product	Primary geography and maturity	Pricing model	Family and household handling	Activity and waiver handling	Could it replace Memba for a 30–300 member outdoor club?	Key judgement
membermojo	UK-focused; used by clubs, associations, and charities across the UK. ²⁷	Extremely cheap: Free up to 50 members, £50/year for 100, £95/year for 500; no membermojo transaction fees; Stripe/PayPal/offline payments supported (with some features requiring £95+). ²⁸	Supports multi-member memberships with a lead member and linked members. This is useful and inexpensive, but still a lead-member model rather than a first-class household with nuanced permissions and lifecycle handling. ²⁹	Good directory/privacy controls, opt-in field-level visibility, attendance registers, membership cards, approval workflows, Rolling/Elapsed/Year-end memberships, and offline payments. I found no native waiver/trip-management evidence beyond attendance/register tooling. ³⁰	Yes, for many small clubs.	Very high price-to-value threat in the UK and for simple clubs generally. It most clearly undermines a “small clubs have to pay real SaaS money” assumption. ³¹

Product	Primary geography and maturity	Pricing model	Family and household handling	Activity and waiver handling	Could it replace Memba for a 30–300 member outdoor club?	Key judgement
Clubforce	Ireland-first, now Ireland + UK; founded 2009 ; has served 2,000+ sports clubs and works with thousands of volunteers. ³²	Membership package shown at €25/month or £25/month paid annually. ³³	Strong family and parent/child club-app context; Clubforce markets a single sports club app for families and flexible membership packages. ³⁴	Strong on sports communication, RSVP/attendance, safeguarded two-way chat, mobile app, import/export into national governing body systems, events, website, and payments. I did not verify outdoor-trip waivers or non-sport club abstractions. ³⁵	Yes, for youth/grassroots sports clubs; less so for broad volunteer orgs.	High beachhead threat in sports-adjacent clubs, lower broader-market threat. It is deeply sports-native and volunteer-aware, but narrower than Memba's long-term market. ³⁶

Product	Primary geography and maturity	Pricing model	Family and household handling	Activity and waiver handling	Could it replace Memba for a 30–300 member outdoor club?	Key judgement
SportLoMo	Irish sports platform with 20+ years of history, deployed in 30+ countries , including Canada, UK, Ireland and beyond. ³⁷	In at least one live rugby-club pricing model, free to clubs with members paying 3.5% + 50c inclusive transaction fees; clubs can choose to absorb or pass on the fee. ³⁸	Explicit support for individual, family, team, and bulk registration plus renewals and upgrades. ³⁹	Very strong on governed sport: safeguarding, medical clearance, compliance rules, events/tournaments, online waivers and consent collection, team app, and Canada/UK governing-body deployments including Rugby Canada, Volleyball BC, Softball Ontario, and Snowsport Scotland. ⁴⁰	Yes, for structured sports and some outdoor bodies; maybe too heavy for an informal volunteer club.	High threat where clubs sit inside governing-body ecosystems; medium threat for simpler volunteer clubs. ⁴¹

Product	Primary geography and maturity	Pricing model	Family and household handling	Activity and waiver handling	Could it replace Memba for a 30-300 member outdoor club?	Key judgement
Amilia	North America-focused platform with strong Canadian presence; official materials say 1,500+ organizations and 6,600 facilities across North America. It raised \$35M in 2025. ⁴²	Standard \$99/month, Advanced \$499/month; payment fees start at 2.85% + \$0.30 plus a 1% service fee on Standard; onboarding starts at \$899. ⁴³	Very strong household handling: individual or multi-person memberships, family accounts, multiple logins inside a family account, fallback wallet handling for recurring billing, and shared credits; however, invited-member access is still fairly broad and not highly customizable. ⁴⁴	Strong on waitlists, waivers, in-person waiver kiosk, permissions groups, exports, and Zapier. This is one of the few vendors with real documented depth on waivers + waitlists + permissions. ⁴⁵	Yes, credibly—especially in Canada.	Top Canadian threat. The main limiter is that it feels more “recreation platform / YMCA / bureau” than “small volunteer club,” and its pricing + onboarding are heavier. ⁴⁶

Product	Primary geography and maturity	Pricing model	Family and household handling	Activity and waiver handling	Could it replace Memba for a 30–300 member outdoor club?	Key judgement
Spond Club	Originated as a Norwegian startup , founded 2014 ; official materials cite 3.3M monthly active users in 2024 and the careers site says 4M active users . 47	Core club management is marketed as free ; payment fees vary by region. In the UK, Spond's 2024/25 published examples include 2.5% + £0.20 transaction fees and £19 + VAT/month for a club website. 48	Good youth-sport onboarding via guardian registration , but I did not verify a first-class household billing model comparable to Amilia or TidyHQ. Confidence: medium. 49	Strong on registration forms, waitlists, events, safeguarding, waivers, exports, digital membership cards, and club roles. 50	Yes, for grassroots sports clubs and some activity clubs.	High beachhead threat, lower broader-market threat. Spond is a serious free/low-cost club operating layer, especially for grassroots sport, but is less persuasive as a formal membership database for broader volunteer orgs. 51
Heylo	Younger community platform; TechCrunch says it was founded in 2019 and raised \$1.5M in 2022; official positioning spans run clubs, cycling groups, social clubs, churches, hiking groups, and volunteer teams. 52	Free base group; paid plans add admin features; payments on the free base plan are 5% + \$0.59 plus Stripe, with lower platform fees on Plus \$19/mo, Pro \$59/mo, and Business \$199/mo . 53	No true household model verified. Guests can be registered for events, but that is not the same as household membership. 54	Strong on events, visible RSVPs, waitlists, membership plans, waivers, member questionnaires, CSV exports, and role-based permissions; available across many countries/languages. 55	Yes, for informal outdoor/activity clubs.	One of the most important beachhead threats. For many hiking/running/cycling groups, Heylo is already “good enough” on events + chat + paid memberships, even if it is weak on households and formal admin controls. 56

Product	Primary geography and maturity	Pricing model	Family and household handling	Activity and waiver handling	Could it replace Memba for a 30–300 member outdoor club?	Key judgement
GroupSpaces	Former UK group-management product; now discontinued since 3 April 2021 . ⁵⁷	No longer relevant. ⁵⁷	No longer relevant. ⁵⁷	No longer relevant. ⁵⁷	No.	Zero current threat. Keep only as background/history. ⁵⁷

Adjacent/utility tools and newly-found/missed competitors

Product	Primary geography and maturity	Pricing model	Family and household handling	Activity and waiver handling	Could it replace Memba?	Key judgement
Teamup	Multi-user calendar utility. The reviewed sources did not clearly state HQ in this pass. ⁵⁸	PLUS \$12/month yearly or \$15 monthly; PRO \$30/month yearly or \$35 monthly. ⁵⁹	None.	Strong calendar permissions only: 9 permission levels , hidden sensitive details, sub-calendars, custom fields. ⁶⁰	No, but it displaces part of the workflow.	Utility threat. It weakens any “we also have a shared calendar” story, but not the membership core. ⁵⁸
Ticket Tailor	Mature low-fee ticketing platform; docs in this pass show multi-currency support including Canada. ⁶¹	Free for up to 5,000 free tickets/year; paid tickets from £0.22 upfront credit or £0.60 pay-as-you-sell plus payment processor fees; 50% charity discount. ⁶¹	None as a membership model, though the check-in app can handle “membership tickets.” ⁶²	Very strong ticketing/check-in, mobile scanning, offline check-in, team access, cash recording, and door sales; not a membership database. ⁶³	No, but it can own event ticketing.	Utility threat. If Memba wants lightweight activities/events, Ticket Tailor sets a very tough price and UX benchmark. ⁶⁴

Product	Primary geography and maturity	Pricing model	Family and household handling	Activity and waiver handling	Could it replace Memba?	Key judgement
Communal	Newly-found direct-fit competitor aimed at community/ member-based organizations. Founding year/funding were not verified from official sources reviewed in this pass. ⁶⁵	Pricing is explicitly based on active members , with optional add-on modules for programs and facility booking. ⁶⁶	Official description says “memberships at the center,” but public household depth was not verifiable in this pass. ⁶⁷	Programs/ bookings/ payments together suggests convergence toward Memba’s “membership + light operations” direction. ⁶⁷	Potentially yes.	High-convergence watchlist threat. The active-member pricing language is uncomfortably close to Memba’s own value story. ⁶⁷
Yapla	Canadian nonprofit/ association platform expanding nationally in 2026; says it supports 100,000 nonprofits . ⁶⁸	Markets free payment and management and 100% free membership management for nonprofits. ⁶⁹	Membership depth exists, but household specifics were not verified in this pass.	Memberships, events, donations, website builder, and nonprofit operations all in one platform. ⁷⁰	For many Canadian nonprofits, yes.	Important missed Canadian competitor. Not obviously outdoor-native, but highly relevant to the long-term volunteer-org market in Canada. ⁷¹

Product	Primary geography and maturity	Pricing model	Family and household handling	Activity and waiver handling	Could it replace Memba?	Key judgement
Members Village	Newly-surfaced Canadian AMS, not an emerging startup but a missed regional competitor. ⁷²	Pricing not verified in this pass.	Batch/group renewals are explicitly included according to the official site snippet. ⁷²	Official positioning covers memberships, renewals, events, payments, and member self-service. ⁷²	Potentially yes, pending deeper audit.	Watchlist for Canada. It deserves a separate pass because it is closer to Memba's long-term association surface area than many flashy community tools are. ⁷²
Givefront	YC-backed nonprofit fintech; TechCrunch reported a \$2M seed in late 2025. ⁷³	Not a membership platform; pricing not verified in this pass.	Not relevant yet.	Built around nonprofit financial management/ spend management, not membership operations. ⁷⁴	No today.	Adjacent watchlist. It could absorb budget/ attention from broader nonprofit ops tooling, but it is not a direct club replacement now. ⁷⁵
Bono	New startup launched in 2025 with \$1.6M pre-seed ; donation matching/ discovery with AI assistance. ⁷⁶	Consumer donation subscription, not club membership pricing. ⁷⁶	Not relevant.	Not relevant to club operations today.	No.	Adjacent only. Worth tracking for broader nonprofit-tech momentum, not for Memba's immediate competitive set. ⁷⁶

Zeffy deep dive

What is real about Zeffy's "free forever" claim

Zeffy's "free forever" claim is not marketing sleight-of-hand in the narrow sense. In the official company materials reviewed here, Zeffy says it charges **no transaction fees, no platform fees, no monthly fees, and no hidden costs**, and that its economics are funded by **voluntary donor contributions** rather than nonprofit charges. In another official explanation, Zeffy says that **two out of three donors** leave a contribution to support Zeffy. That makes the model real in the sense that the nonprofit can genuinely see a \$0 software bill and \$0 payment-fee deduction from Zeffy itself. ⁶

The sustainability signal is meaningful, too. Zeffy's official materials claim **100,000+ nonprofits** use the platform. That is enough adoption to treat the model as proven, not theoretical. Still, I did **not** find a public audited breakdown of contribution conversion, average contribution percentage, gross margin, or long-term cohort economics in the sources reviewed, so any claim beyond "the model exists and appears to work at scale" would be overstated. Confidence: high on the pricing mechanics; medium on long-run durability because the economics disclosed publicly are still top-line, not audited operating detail. ⁶

What nonprofits actually pay in practice

For the nonprofit organization itself, the **headline price can genuinely be zero**. The economic "catch" is shifted to the payer experience: the donor or member is asked to support Zeffy voluntarily at checkout. Zeffy explicitly says the contribution is voluntary, and that user generosity is what keeps the platform free. In practice, this means a club using Zeffy can tell itself that software and processing are free, while some portion of supporters absorb extra spend through the optional contribution prompt. That is strategically important for Memba because it means "no Memba surcharge on payments" is not enough by itself; Zeffy can counter with "we don't surcharge the organization at all." ⁶

The right competitive reading is therefore not "Zeffy is fake-free"; it is "Zeffy is **organizationally free but checkout-mediated**." That distinction matters. Some volunteer clubs will love it. Others—especially member-funded clubs with recurring community relationships—may dislike asking members to subsidize the software provider at every payment interaction. That emotional and governance discomfort is likely the surviving angle for Memba, but it is a **secondary** angle, not a primary wedge. ⁶

Where Zeffy still falls short for Memba's buyer

The audited public evidence in this pass does **not** show Zeffy matching the club-operating requirements that matter most to Memba's beachhead: first-class households, per-person member access in a family context, club directory privacy, volunteer succession controls, and outdoor-club activity workflows like trip leaders, expressions of interest, approvals, waitlists tied to membership state, waivers per participant, and emergency-contact handling in a club-native way. I am deliberately writing that as a **documentation-based conclusion**, not an absolute feature absence claim, because Zeffy's public materials reviewed here were strong on pricing and high-level nonprofit positioning, but weaker on these club-native specifics. Confidence: medium. ⁶

So the direct strategic answer is:

- **Does Zeffy erode Memba's fair-pricing advantage?** Yes, heavily. A “fairly priced dues/payments/events system” is a weak primary story when a real competitor can say “your organization pays nothing.” ⁶
- **What survives?** The parts Zeffy does not obviously model: household complexity, volunteer handoff, privacy/admin nuance, and activity/waiver workflows for member organizations rather than fundraising databases. ⁷⁷

My bottom-line assessment: **Zeffy probably kills “fair pricing” as a standalone wedge.** Memba should treat price as a **qualifier**—predictable, no lock-in, no weird surcharges—while expecting to win on **club-native domain fit**, not on being “the reasonable-priced option.” Confidence: high. ⁷⁸

Emerging entrants briefing

The newcomers and newly-surfaced competitors that matter most

The most important newly-found direct-convergence name is **Communal**. Its official positioning is unusually close to Memba's intended shape: it is “built for community and member-based organizations” that run **memberships, bookings, programs, and payments together**, and its pricing language explicitly says it follows **active members, not seat counts**. That is not just adjacent; it directly attacks a future Memba narrative around fair, active-member-based pricing and a unified operating model for volunteer/community organizations. The biggest gap in this pass is that I could not verify founding year or funding from official sources reviewed here, so it remains a high-priority follow-up. Even with that gap, Communal is the clearest “someone is building toward the same hill” signal I found. ⁶⁷

Heylo also belongs in the emerging-threat conversation, even though it is no longer brand-new. TechCrunch says it was founded in **2019** and raised **\$1.5M** in 2022 after bootstrapping to profitability. Since then, it has clearly converged toward club-like operations: memberships, paid events, waivers, waitlists, exports, role permissions, and country/language availability broad enough to matter outside the US. If Memba's beachhead is outdoor/activity clubs, Heylo is dangerous precisely because it can win clubs that are culturally “community/event first” before they ever feel the pain that would force them into a true AMS. ⁷⁹

Givefront is not a direct replacement today, but it is the sort of adjacent startup worth tracking because it shows active venture attention returning to nonprofit infrastructure. TechCrunch reported a **\$2M** seed and YC backing in late 2025, with the product aimed at nonprofit financial infrastructure and spend management. That does not solve membership operations yet, but it is the sort of product that can expand outward—first into finance ops, later into constituent and member workflows—once it has a trusted base system. I would watch it for Memba's **broader volunteer-org ambition**, not the beachhead. ⁸⁰

Bono is newer and more distant. TechCrunch reported a **\$1.6M pre-seed** in 2025 for an AI-assisted charitable giving platform. It is not a Memba competitor today, but it is another signal that donor/nonprofit workflows are attracting new product energy, especially AI-native product packaging. That matters because the broader market Memba eventually wants to enter will not be static: new donors, payments, fundraising, and volunteer tooling will keep appearing around the edges. ⁷⁶

The missed non-US competitors that should now be on the board

The biggest “how did the first pass miss this?” names are **Yapla** and **Members Village** in Canada. Yapla is not especially young, but its 2026 push as a **Canadian all-in-one nonprofit software** platform with **free membership management** makes it strategically relevant to Memba’s geography and to the “free/fair” narrative. Members Village is also not a startup story, but it appears to be a serious Canadian association-management option that was absent from the first pass and deserves a dedicated audit. ⁸¹

The newcomers most likely to become real threats

My threat call-outs are:

Communal — because the pricing logic and problem framing converge directly on Memba’s future story. Confidence: medium, because company-structure/funding data were not verified in this pass. ⁶⁷

Heylo — because it is already good enough for many hiking/run/cycling/social groups, and products that become “the club’s social/event home” often capture the right to grow into membership and payments later. Confidence: high. ⁸²

Yapla — because Memba’s pilot geography is Canada, and a Canadian platform publicly promoting free nonprofit membership management deserves respect even if it is not outdoor-native. Confidence: medium-high. ⁸³

Canadian and Commonwealth market note

The Canada/Commonwealth correction is real. **Amilia** is a serious Canadian/North American benchmark in households, waivers, waitlists, and permissions. **SportLoMo** has concrete Canadian credibility through deployments such as **Rugby Canada**, **Volleyball BC**, and **Softball Ontario**. **Yapla** has a current Canadian expansion story and free membership positioning. Together, those three change the question in Canada from “is there anything local?” to “which local/regional alternative does the prospect already know?” ⁸⁴

In the **UK and Ireland**, the volunteer-club field is even denser. **membermojo** is astonishingly cheap and tailor-made for small clubs. **Clubforce** is deeply rooted in Irish grassroots sport and volunteer realities. **SportLoMo** is strong wherever governing-body registration, compliance, or competition structure matter. **Spond Club** is a modern free/low-cost default in grassroots sport. This means Memba cannot assume that UK/Ireland volunteer clubs are sitting on spreadsheets waiting for a “modern affordable” tool; many already have modern-enough options. ⁸⁵

In **Australia and New Zealand**, **TidyHQ** is the standout regional benchmark because it combines club-native breadth, volunteer governance language, strong family memberships, and API/integration extensibility. It also explicitly markets across Australia, New Zealand, the UK, Ireland, and the US. For Memba, that makes TidyHQ both a competitor and an existence proof that a modern volunteer-club platform can travel well across Commonwealth markets. ⁸⁶

A final regional point on payments: the markets in scope are already full of tools that either price **at \$0 to the organization**, **at very low annual club rates**, or **with pass-through processing only**. Zeffy, HelloAsso,

Spond, Teamup-plus-other-tools, Ticket Tailor, membermojo, SportLoMo club pricing, and Yapla all push buyer expectations downward in one way or another. That means payment-surcharge sensitivity should be treated as **high** across Canada and the Commonwealth—not because every buyer demands \$0, but because a prospect can very plausibly say, “why am I paying a meaningful subscription when I can assemble something much cheaper?” ⁸⁷

Threat ranking and differentiation impact

Beachhead threat ranking

This table is ordered for **Memba’s starting beachhead: volunteer-run outdoor/activity clubs, roughly 30–300 members, especially in Canada/Commonwealth**. Rows marked **carry-forward** were part of the prior AMS set but were **not re-audited in depth in this gap pass**, so those placements are lower confidence.

Beachhead order	Competitor	Threat level	Why
Top	TidyHQ	Very high	Best combination of volunteer-club breadth, family handling, permissions, events, integrations, and Commonwealth relevance. ⁸⁸
Top	Amilia	Very high	Strongest Canadian audited alternative on households + waivers + waitlists + permissions; heavier and pricier, but very credible. ⁸⁹
Top	Heylo	Very high	Especially dangerous for hiking/running/cycling/ social-outdoor groups that prize events, RSVPs, chat, and casual paid memberships. ⁹⁰
Top	Zeffy	High	The biggest price anchor. It can replace simple dues/payments/events even if it cannot replace the full club operating model. ⁶
High	Spond Club	High	Strong free/low-cost default for grassroots sport and parent/guardian-heavy clubs. ⁹¹
High	membermojo	High	Tiny-club economics are brutally good, especially in the UK. Lead-member family support is “good enough” for many clubs. ⁹²
High	SportLoMo	High	Powerful when the club sits in a formal sports/ governing-body ecosystem; less perfect for informal outdoor clubs. ⁴¹
High	Clubforce	Medium-high	Very strong for grassroots/team sports clubs, weaker for broader volunteer associations or non-sport outdoor clubs. ³⁶

Beachhead order	Competitor	Threat level	Why
Medium	Ticket Tailor	Medium	Not a replacement, but it sets a harsh benchmark for any paid-events/check-in component. ⁶⁴
Medium	Teamup	Medium	Similar story for shared calendars/permissions. ⁹³
Medium	Communal	Medium	Directly convergent, but still under-verified. ⁶⁷
Medium	Yapla	Medium	Canada relevance plus free language make it a real watchlist name. ⁸³
Medium	Givebutter	Medium	Could win clubs that behave like donor organizations more than member organizations. ⁹⁴
Medium	Donorbox	Low-medium	Similar to Givebutter, but weaker on club-native workflows. ¹⁶
Low	HelloAsso	Low for beachhead	Important strategically, but France-only. ⁹⁵
Low	Members Village	Low-medium	Needs a deeper Canadian audit before ranking higher. ⁷²
Low	Wild Apricot	Medium, carry-forward	Still a legacy default many clubs know; not refreshed here.
Low	ClubExpress	Medium, carry-forward	Deep volunteer-club heritage, but not refreshed here.
Low	Join It	Medium, carry-forward	Light modern membership stack; not refreshed here.
Low	Raklet	Medium, carry-forward	Broad all-in-one community/member scope; not refreshed here.
Low	MemberPlanet	Low-medium, carry-forward	Was in the first pass, but not refreshed here.
Low	Memberful	Low, carry-forward	Stronger on creator/media memberships than volunteer clubs.
Low	Mighty Networks	Low, carry-forward	Community-first rather than dues/club-admin-first.
None	GroupSpaces	None	Discontinued. ⁵⁷
Watch only	Givefront	Adjacent	Finance infrastructure, not club replacement. ⁷⁴

Beachhead order	Competitor	Threat level	Why
Watch only	Bono	Adjacent	Donation/discovery startup, not club ops. ⁷⁶

Broader volunteer-organization ambition ranking

For the long-term market—broader volunteer-run membership organizations beyond outdoor clubs—the order changes. Fundraising-first stacks and generic association tools rise, while sports-native specialists fall somewhat.

Broader-market order	Competitor	Threat level	Why
Top	TidyHQ	Very high	Best cross-category fit of the newly-audited field: memberships, permissions, content visibility, events, finances, docs, integrations, volunteer governance language. ⁹⁶
Top	Amilia	Very high	Broad operations depth, especially where organizations mix memberships with activities/facilities and want family accounts. ⁸⁹
Top	Givebutter	High	Broad nonprofit adoption and free CRM make it a serious alternative where “membership” is engagement + recurring giving. ⁹⁷
Top	Donorbox	High	Large international nonprofit footprint with memberships, events, and donor self-service. ⁹⁸
High	Zeffy	High	Again, because price expectations matter across the whole sector, not just the beachhead. ⁶
High	Yapla	High	Canadian nonprofit breadth and free membership language make it strategically relevant to the long-term vision. ⁸³
High	Wild Apricot	High, carry-forward	Legacy broad-category AMS threat, not refreshed here.
High	Raklet	High, carry-forward	Broad all-in-one member/community scope, not refreshed here.
High	Join It	Medium-high, carry-forward	Light but broad club/association fit, not refreshed here.
Medium	Heylo	Medium-high	Great for community groups; weaker for formal/family/association complexity. ⁹⁹

Broader-market order	Competitor	Threat level	Why
Medium	membermojo	Medium	Very compelling on small-club economics, but more limited outside its UK club niche. ³¹
Medium	Communal	Medium-high	Could rise quickly because its framing is broader than sports and close to Memba's long-term mission. ⁶⁷
Medium	Members Village	Medium	Potentially more relevant long-term than beachhead, pending deeper audit. ⁷²
Medium	ClubExpress	Medium, carry-forward	Traditional AMS presence; not refreshed here.
Medium	MemberPlanet	Medium, carry-forward	Prior-pass incumbent; not refreshed here.
Medium	Mighty Networks	Medium, carry-forward	More relevant in broader community-led memberships than in outdoor-club admin.
Lower	Spond Club	Medium	Sports-led and strong, but narrower in long-term market fit. ¹⁰⁰
Lower	SportLoMo	Medium	Huge in governed sport; less relevant outside sports. ¹⁰¹
Lower	Clubforce	Medium	Same reason: very sports-forward. ¹⁰²
Lower	HelloAsso	Low outside France	Strategic model proof, limited geographic applicability. ¹⁰³
Utility	Ticket Tailor	Utility	Event-ticketing specialist, not an org system. ⁶⁴
Utility	Teamup	Utility	Calendar specialist, not an org system. ⁵⁸
None	GroupSpaces	None	Discontinued. ⁵⁷
Watch	Givefront	Adjacent	Could grow into adjacent ops territory. ⁷⁴
Watch	Bono	Adjacent	Not a direct organization-management threat today. ⁷⁶

Differentiation impact

Here is the blunt answer on Memba's hypotheses.

Fair, predictable pricing by active members is **weakened—possibly dead as a primary wedge**. Zeffy and HelloAsso show that “free forever via voluntary contribution” is viable. Spond Club normalizes free club administration with payment fees. Givebutter offers a free CRM core. membermojo sets a startlingly low floor for tiny clubs. Ticket Tailor and Teamup make it easy to patch together narrow functions cheaply. Memba can still be competitively priced, but “we’re fairer than the incumbents” is no longer a strong opening line on its own. ¹⁰⁴

Household/family memberships are **still the strongest surviving wedge**, but only if Memba goes deeper than “linked family members.” TidyHQ is strong. Amilia is strong. membermojo is decent but lead-member-centric. Clubforce and Spond are parent/guardian-friendly, but not obviously full household domain models. The opportunity is still there if Memba handles one payer, multiple individuals, individual logins/waivers/profiles, child-to-adult transitions, and nuanced access control better than these products do. ¹⁰⁵

Renewal + payment automation is **unchanged to moderately weakened**. Many tools now do recurring billing or renewal reminders. The edge survives only if Memba handles the messy cases—calendar-fixed versus rolling, offline payments, admin corrections, renewal grace logic, partial family changes, late renewals, and year-to-year volunteer continuity—better than the field. ¹⁰⁶

Volunteer-admin simplicity and handoff are **strengthened** as a differentiation theme. Public materials across the field talk a lot about features and a lot less about succession, control transfer, reduced institutional memory loss, and safe volunteer turnover. TidyHQ comes closest by explicitly emphasizing committee/governance controls, logs, and custom admin access, but even there the market language is still more “admin permissions” than “board handoff.” This remains a strong Memba narrative if the product actually operationalizes it. ¹⁰⁷

Lightweight activity/event management with waivers and member-only visibility is **strengthened**, especially for the beachhead. Plenty of tools do pieces: Spond does waivers and waitlists; SportLoMo does waivers/consents/compliance; Ticket Tailor does ticketing/check-in; Amilia does waivers and waitlists; Heylo does events/waitlists/waivers/chat. Very few combine the exact outdoor-club mix of member-state-aware activity workflows, approvals, emergency context, privacy, volunteer usability, and household logic. That combination is still open territory. ¹⁰⁸

Easy data export and leave-anytime portability are **strengthened** as trust builders. Several credible alternatives market exports, CSVs, or Google Sheets connectivity, which means users increasingly expect portability rather than tolerate lock-in. That makes portability less differentiating as a slogan, but more differentiating as a proof-of-trust standard—especially if Memba makes full-fidelity household, payment, waiver, and event export genuinely simple. ¹⁰⁹

Open questions and limitations

This pass is strongest on the **required gap categories**—free models, Commonwealth club-native tools, and emerging entrants—and intentionally weaker on the **original AMS set**, which I carried into the revised ranking without re-auditing every product page in this report. Those carry-forward rankings should be treated as **lower-confidence comparative judgements**, not refreshed factual vendor profiles.

I could **not** verify every requested item symmetrically for every vendor. In particular, public review evidence was uneven; some products had strong visible public review or testimonial signals, while others had sparse or hard-to-parse public feedback. I also encountered several cases where an important absence—especially household nuance or waiver depth—was **not explicitly documented either way**. Where that happened, I treated it as “not verified in public sources reviewed,” not as a categorical absence.

The largest follow-up gaps I would most want closed in a future pass are: **Communal’s founding/funding/traction details**, a **dedicated Canadian audit of Members Village**, a **fresh side-by-side re-audit of the original AMS incumbents using 2026 pricing and feature pages**, and a more systematic scrape of **real customer complaints** for the smaller club-native tools.

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